

D755

Assessment for Special Education

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

Method © 2026 Erik Daniel Lindquist — Course Mastery Coach, armored drill. Items drafted with AI assistance under his direction.

How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A special education teacher wants to know whether a student can add fractions with unlike denominators at 80% accuracy. The student transferred in October and receives speech services. Which assessment fits?

- A. A criterion-referenced probe on adding unlike fractions.
- B. A speech-language assessment.
- C. A percentile rank from last year's state test.
- D. A norm-referenced achievement battery.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A student's reading composite is 85 on a test with mean 100 and SD 15. He is in sixth grade and his teacher describes him as hardworking. About what percentile is this, and what does it mean?

- A. The 85th percentile.
- B. About the 16th percentile; he scored as well as or better than about 16% of same-age peers.
- C. He answered 85% correctly.
- D. About the 2nd percentile.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

On a test with mean 100 and SD 15, a student scores at about the 98th percentile. What is her standard score?

- A. About 70
- B. About 115
- C. 98
- D. About 130

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A student scores 72 on a cognitive test (mean 100, SD 15) where the SEM is 3. The district uses 70 as one part of an intellectual disability decision. The test took 90 minutes. What is the 95% confidence range?

- A. 66 to 78, so the true score may be above or below the cutoff.
- B. 57 to 87
- C. Exactly 72; the score is precise.
- D. 69 to 75

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A report says a student's 68% confidence interval is 88 to 96. What are the obtained score and SEM?

- A. Score 92, SEM 2
- B. Score 92, SEM 4
- C. Score 92, SEM 8
- D. Score 88, SEM 8

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A reading fluency test gives nearly identical scores each time a student takes it, but it uses only nonsense words. A district with 12 schools wants to use it to judge reading comprehension. What is the main concern?

- A. It is unreliable.
- B. It needs more schools to be valid.
- C. It is valid because it is reliable.
- D. It is reliable but not valid for judging comprehension.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A fourth grader earns a grade-equivalent score of 7.2 in math. His parents, who both teach at a local college, ask whether he should move to seventh-grade math. What is the best answer?

- A. No, since grade-equivalent scores are always wrong.
- B. No; it means he did as well as an average seventh grader on fourth-grade test content, not that he knows seventh-grade math.
- C. Yes, the score shows he is ready for seventh-grade math.
- D. Yes, because his parents are teachers.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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8.

A teacher needs weekly data to see if a second grader's reading is improving. The school uses a unit-based basal series, and the student has a pet rabbit. Which measure fits best?

- A. A reading log about the rabbit.
- B. End-of-unit basal tests.
- C. Weekly one-minute oral reading fluency probes at the same level.
- D. An annual state test.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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9.

A school's reading screener flags students below the 20th percentile. Last year, several students who were not flagged later struggled a lot. The principal likes color-coded reports. What change would reduce these misses, and what is the cost?

- A. Change the report colors.
- B. Lower the cutoff to the 10th percentile.
- C. Raise the cutoff (for example, to the 30th percentile); more students at risk are caught, but more who are not at risk are flagged.
- D. Raise the cutoff; this removes all errors.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A screener flags many students who turn out to read just fine, and staff are overwhelmed with follow-up testing. What cutoff change reduces this problem, and what is the risk?

- A.** Lower the cutoff; fewer false positives, but more at-risk students may be missed.
- B.** Lower the cutoff; there is no downside.
- C.** Raise the cutoff; fewer students will be flagged.
- D.** Stop screening, since it causes errors.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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11.

A student born on 2015-09-20 is tested on 2025-04-12 in the school’s new testing room. What is her chronological age in years-months-days?

- A.** 10-5-8
- B.** 9-7-22
- C.** 9-6-22
- D.** 10 years

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student is 8-3-15 on a test date of 2025-10-25. What is her birth date?

- A.** 2017-10-25
- B.** 2017-07-15
- C.** 2033-01-10
- D.** 2017-07-10

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A special education teacher wants to know whether a student can add fractions with unlike denominators at 80% accuracy. ~~The student transferred in October and receives speech services.~~ Which assessment fits?

Target word: choose test type **Decides:** Comparing to a mastery standard.

A	Correct	Measures performance against a set standard.
B	Camouflage	Uses the speech detail; unrelated to the math skill.
C	Adjacent category	A rank does not show mastery of this skill.
D	Confusion set	Compares to peers, not to mastery of a skill.

2. Answer B Concept 2

A student's reading composite is 85 on a test with mean 100 and SD 15. ~~He is in sixth grade and his teacher describes him as hardworking.~~ About what percentile is this, and what does it mean?

Target word: interpret standard score **Decides:** 85 is 1 SD below the mean.

A	Confusion set	Confuses a standard score with a percentile.
B	Correct	1 SD below the mean is about the 16th percentile.
C	Adjacent category	A standard score is not percent correct.
D	Wrong stem number	That is 2 SD below (70).

3. Answer D Concept 2 · transfer

On a test with mean 100 and SD 15, a student scores at about the 98th percentile. What is her standard score?

Target word: solve for score from percentile **Decides:** 98th percentile is about +2 SD.

A	Inverted operation	Subtracts 2 SD instead of adding.
B	Dropped element	Only +1 SD, about the 84th percentile.
C	Confusion set	Treats the percentile as a standard score.
D	Correct	$100 + 2 \times 15 = 130$.

4. Answer A Concept 3

A student scores 72 on a cognitive test (mean 100, SD 15) where the SEM is 3. The district uses 70 as one part of an intellectual disability decision. ~~The test took 90 minutes.~~ What is the 95% confidence range?

Target word: confidence band **Decides:** $\pm 2 \text{ SEM} = \pm 6$.

A	Correct	$72 \pm 6 = 66 \text{ to } 78$; the band crosses 70.
B	Wrong stem number	Uses the SD (15) instead of the SEM.
C	Absolute language	All scores contain error.
D	Dropped element	$\pm 1 \text{ SEM}$ is only about a 68% band.

5. Answer B Concept 3 • transfer

A report says a student's 68% confidence interval is 88 to 96. What are the obtained score and SEM?

Target word: solve backward **Decides:** Midpoint is the score; half the width is 1 SEM.

A	Confusion set	Treats the band as ± 2 SEM, which is the 95% band.
B	Correct	$(88 + 96) / 2 = 92$; $96 - 92 = 4$.
C	Inverted operation	Uses the full width instead of half.
D	Wrong stem number	Uses the lower bound as the score.

6. Answer D Concept 4

A reading fluency test gives nearly identical scores each time a student takes it, but it uses only nonsense words. A district with 12 schools wants to use it to judge reading comprehension. What is the main concern?

Target word: reliability vs. validity **Decides:** Consistent but measuring a different skill.

A	Inverted operation	Scores are consistent.
B	Camouflage	Sample size is not the issue here.
C	Confusion set	Reliability is necessary but not sufficient.
D	Correct	Consistency does not make it measure comprehension.

7. Answer B Concept 5

A fourth grader earns a grade-equivalent score of 7.2 in math. His parents, ~~who both teach at a local college,~~ ask whether he should move to seventh-grade math. What is the best answer?

Target word: interpret grade equivalents **Decides:** A GE compares raw scores; it does not show mastery of seventh-grade content.

A	Absolute language	They are accurate but limited in meaning.
B	Correct	GEs are easily misread as placement levels.
C	Inverted operation	Misreads the GE as a placement level.
D	Camouflage	Irrelevant to the score's meaning.

8. Answer C Concept 6

A teacher needs weekly data to see if a second grader's reading is improving. The school uses a unit-based basal series, and ~~the student has a pet rabbit.~~ Which measure fits best?

Target word: progress measure choice **Decides:** Brief, repeated, standardized general outcome.

A	Camouflage	Irrelevant.
B	Adjacent category	Each unit covers different content, so scores are not comparable over time.
C	Correct	CBM gives comparable weekly data on overall reading.
D	Dropped element	Drops frequency; once a year cannot monitor weekly.

9. Answer C Concept 7

A school's reading screener flags students below the 20th percentile. Last year, several students who were not flagged later struggled a lot. ~~The principal likes color-coded reports.~~ What change would reduce these misses, and what is the cost?

Target word: cutoff trade-off **Decides:** Misses are false negatives; raise the cutoff.

A	Camouflage	Irrelevant.
B	Inverted operation	Would miss even more students.
C	Correct	Fewer false negatives come with more false positives.
D	Absolute language	Screening always trades one error for another.

10. Answer A Concept 7 · transfer

A screener flags many students who turn out to read just fine, and staff are overwhelmed with follow-up testing. What cutoff change reduces this problem, and what is the risk?

Target word: reverse: reduce false positives **Decides:** Too many false positives; lower the cutoff.

A	Correct	A stricter cutoff flags fewer students, raising false negatives.
B	Dropped element	Drops the false-negative trade-off.
C	Inverted operation	Raising the cutoff flags more students.
D	Absolute language	All screening has error; the answer is balancing it.

11. Answer C Concept 8

A student born on 2015-09-20 is tested on 2025-04-12 ~~in the school's new testing room.~~ What is her chronological age in years-months-days?

Target word: compute age **Decides:** Borrow days and months.

A	Inverted operation	Subtracts smaller from larger in each column ($20 - 12 = 8$, $9 - 4 = 5$) instead of borrowing.
B	Dropped element	Borrowed for days but did not reduce the months.
C	Correct	Days: $12 - 20$ needs a borrow, $42 - 20 = 22$; months: $3 - 9$ needs a borrow, $15 - 9 = 6$; years: $2024 - 2015 = 9$.
D	Absolute language	Rounds up; norms need exact age.

12. Answer D Concept 8 · transfer

A student is 8-3-15 on a test date of 2025-10-25. What is her birth date?

Target word: solve for birth date **Decides:** Subtract age from test date.

A	Dropped element	Drops the months and days.
B	Wrong stem number	Uses the age's days (15) as the birth day.
C	Inverted operation	Adds age to the test date.
D	Correct	$25 - 15 = 10$ days; $10 - 3 = 7$ months; $2025 - 8 = 2017$.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	6	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	4	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	3	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	5	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	5	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Norm-reference d vs. criterion-referenced	Norm-referenced tests compare a student to a norm group; criterion-referenced tests compare performance to a fixed standard of mastery.	Using a percentile to say whether a student mastered a skill.	“Compared to peers” vs. “met the standard.”
2	Standard scores and percentiles	Most ability and achievement tests use mean 100, SD 15; 85 is 1 SD below (about 16th percentile), 115 is 1 SD above (about 84th).	Treating a standard score of 85 as ‘85% correct.’	A standard score and a question about rank or distance from the mean.
3	Standard error of measurement and confidence bands	Every score has error; a confidence interval (score $\pm$ SEM for about 68%, $\pm$ 2 SEM for about 95%) shows the range where the true score likely falls.	Treating an obtained score as exact, especially near a cutoff.	A score near an eligibility cutoff and an SEM value.
4	Reliability vs. validity	Reliability is consistency; validity is whether the test measures what it claims for the intended use; a test can be reliable but not valid.	Assuming a consistent test must be valid.	A test gives stable scores but measures the wrong thing.
5	Grade-equivalent scores	A grade equivalent shows the grade whose average student got the same raw score; it does not mean the student can do work at that grade level.	Placing a student in grade-level material by grade-equivalent score.	“Reads at a 7.2 grade level.”
6	Curriculum-based measurement	CBM uses brief, standardized, repeated probes of a general outcome (such as words read correctly per minute) to screen and to monitor progress.	Using end-of-unit tests or mastery checks as progress-monitoring data.	A need for weekly, comparable data on overall growth.
7	Screening errors: false positives and false negatives	Raising a screening cutoff catches more students at risk (fewer false negatives) but flags more who are not (more false positives).	Thinking one cutoff can remove both kinds of error.	A team debating where to set a screening cut score.
8	Calculating chronological age	Subtract birth date from test date (year-month-day), borrowing 30 days or 12 months as needed; norms depend on exact age.	Subtracting without borrowing, or rounding up to the nearest year.	A test date and a birth date.

Course scope (public description): Assessment for Special Education prepares special education teachers to use multiple methods of assessment and data sources in making educational decisions concerning the student and their learning environment. This course is designed to help provide an understanding of how assessment data is used during screening in multitiered systems of support (MTSS), the eligibility process, the evaluation process, progress monitoring, and data-based instructional decision making.